



Cambridge IGCSE™

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/11

Paper 1 Reading

October/November 2024

INSERT

2 hours

INFORMATION

- This insert contains the reading texts.
- You may annotate this insert and use the blank spaces for planning. **Do not write your answers** on the insert.



This document has **8** pages. Any blank pages are indicated.

Read **Text A**, and then answer **Questions 1(a)–(e)** on the question paper.

Text A: *Bees*

A bee colony is populated by a queen, about 200 male drones and thousands of underdeveloped female workers. The queen is the largest member of the colony due to the workers having fed her a special diet.

The queen is the mother of all the workers and also the male drones in the hive. She remains inside, attended by the workers who groom and feed her. The sole purpose of the drone is to mate with her so that the hive continues.

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Bees have different characteristics that make them suited to pollinating certain plants. For example, the early bumblebee's small size and agility allow it to enter plants with drooping flowers. The larger garden bumblebee is better at pollinating the deep flowers because its longer tongue can reach deep inside them.

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Plants can only grow because of pollination. Bees' transference of pollen between flowering plants enables a plant to reproduce and produce food. The cycle of a plant's life keeps turning in this way.

So thanks to these small creatures, we enjoy a range of foods from orchard fruits to coffee and vanilla. And if you are wearing cotton, that's because a cotton plant was pollinated. Maybe in your lessons at school you have come across bees too. This would be because many poets, artists, authors and scientists have found them a fascinating subject to study.

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But bees are in trouble. Nowadays, many of us are aware of how human decisions impact on bee populations. A few organisations try to educate the public on how the pesticides we use on crops to make our food safer and more prolific are toxic to bees, damaging their mental capacities and ability to reproduce. Bee habitats, such as ponds, trees and flowers, are wiped out by our need to urbanise and build houses and by intensive farming methods. We really need to ask ourselves how much our thoughtlessness and selfishness might be costing us all.

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Read **Text B**, and then answer **Question 1(f)** on the question paper.

Text B: *Beekeeping*

This text is advice given by a practising beekeeper to other people considering keeping bees.

Why be a beekeeper? Is it because you like honey? Want to help with local pollination? Aid the global honeybee crisis? Beekeeping is hard work and a considerable responsibility, so needs a lot of thought.

Actually, you may have no choice in the matter if beekeeping is forbidden in your area. My town requires hive registrations. You might just live somewhere where there are no restrictions on beekeeping, but that would be lucky.

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Okay, so you are allowed to keep bees. It took me a while to receive a reply to my request for help from the online beekeeping organisation I contacted, presumably because the beekeepers were all out and about pursuing their hobby. In the end I discovered that there was a lot of advice out there, which I sifted through, finding some of it anecdotal and specific to certain circumstances rather than of use to me.

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Naturally, I assumed that my spacesuit-like body and head protection would shield me from stings. Choosing clothing that is effective in keeping an angry swarm at bay is important, but bear in mind there is always the occasional unavoidable sting. Yes, it's happened to me even in a full beekeeping suit with gloves.

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My bees fly up to eight kilometres when out foraging for nectar and pollen, and that's fine as I live in a rural area. Your urban neighbours may not be so happy about you keeping beehives in your back garden while they are out enjoying the sun.

And that brings me onto another matter. I have a field for my hives. They should be placed on a level site, receive sun during the day and be sheltered from strong winds, as well as being easily accessible for you and their stripy occupants.

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In the beginning, I bought a heavy hive, intending to give my bees a robust and safe home. By harvest time, when the hives were full of honey, my aching back taught me I needed to purchase a lighter construction. Still now, I need a trusted friend (a fellow beekeeper) to help me shift those hives around.

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The same friend and I have a reciprocal arrangement to look after our bees when either of us goes away. Bees can't be left for long periods. Hiring someone else to look after your bees can be costly and you need to be sure that person knows what they're doing.

I spent a lot of money getting started and I made a few expensive purchasing errors, from heavy hives to beekeeping accessories that I never actually used.

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Read **Text C**, and then answer **Questions 2(a)–(d)** and **Question 3** on the question paper.

Text C: *The business venture*

Damian and Abdul were school friends. As adults, they have gone into business together.

Tuesday evening, driving the van home, Damian laughs in pleasure.

‘Sold out in one morning. Brilliant work for our very first day at the market! I’ll try some new ranges and we can take double to sell next week.’

Abdul does not share Damian’s optimism. ‘We don’t want to go too quickly, and the van freezer isn’t very big,’ he cautions.

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A few months earlier, Damian and Abdul had been relaxing in Damian’s field, near his beehives. It had been the first mild morning for many months and the two men were sipping Damian’s home-made acacia honey and berry smoothies.

The delicate tracery of acacia leaves cast a dancing dappled shade over the beehives. A worker bee, one of the first to venture uncertainly out of the hive that morning, drew dizzy spirals in the air, as it orientated itself, sensing the nectar in the newly budding flowers. Damian could faintly hear the drones inside the hive humming in reverential attendance on their queen. He looked up. Any day now those acacia trees would burst into flower and cascades of clustered white blossom would turn the trees silver. Then this solitary worker would be accompanied by hundreds of other labourers, all intent on drinking their fill of nectar.

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‘I agree with that little bee,’ announced Damian, smacking his lips in pleasure at the taste of honey and berries. ‘We should venture out of our own hives and taste the sweet nectar of life. Get ahead of the crowd. Nice big shop in the middle of town.’

‘All the online advice is that small businesses should start slowly. No risk-taking. Trying it out just once a week in the local market is best,’ replied Abdul.

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‘There isn’t another smoothie store in town, and no one who makes smoothies like I do!’ Damian protested.

A few weeks later, Damian conceded defeat when Abdul showed him his painstaking work. ‘My survey suggests that people in the town like smoothies, but they are not prepared to pay too high a price for them. We need to encourage them to try ours.’

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Facts and figures didn’t interest Damian. He wandered into the house to continue working on his smoothie ranges. All his creations were conventionally sweet: cherries, pineapples and strawberries blended with the bees’ acacia honey, lumps of ice and different milks. He wanted to diversify.

A worker bee swung through the kitchen window and settled momentarily by the honey jar. It started to carefully probe droplets of honey that had puddled on the work top, smiling to itself in self-congratulatory glee. 'What shall I turn my talents to next?' Damian asked the bee. The bee's segmented antennae rotated through a full 90 degrees, and then folded outwards, as if in a quizzical hand gesture. Its gossamer wings reclined, and a contemplative silence consumed the kitchen. 'You're no help!' reprimanded Damian playfully.

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Damian returned to Abdul. 'How about a savoury range?' he suggested. 'I was thinking of pizza ☐ '

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Abdul didn't answer. He was looking thoughtful. 'We could put a few of those cherry ones on special offer to attract buyers. I've also been looking at the amount of packaging we plan to use and whether it is eco-friendly. And we need a portable freezer and a big van.'

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Damian smiles, remembering back to that conversation. He parks the van and observes the beehives. A huge swarm of bees flies over the top and up towards the acacia tree.

Abdul watches too. 'I guess we could have rivals if other people realise how successful our business is.'

'Then we should think bigger and get ahead. A shop that is open every day of the week. I could live there.'

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'But then who would look after your bees?' asks Abdul, as the two men contemplate the crowds of tiny golden bodies intent on pursuing their own businesses in the white blossom.

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FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/11

Paper 1 Reading

October/November 2024

2 hours

You must answer on the question paper.

You will need: Insert (enclosed)

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer **all** questions.
- Use a black or dark blue pen.
- Write your name, centre number and candidate number in the boxes at the top of the page.
- Write your answer to each question in the space provided.
- Do **not** use an erasable pen or correction fluid.
- Do **not** write on any bar codes.
- If additional space is needed, you should use the lined pages at the end of this booklet; the question number or numbers must be clearly shown.
- Dictionaries are **not** allowed.

INFORMATION

- The total mark for this paper is 80.
- The number of marks for each question or part question is shown in brackets [].
- The insert contains the reading texts.

This document has **16** pages. Any blank pages are indicated.



Read **Text A, Bees**, in the insert and then answer **Questions 1(a)–(e)** on this question paper.

Question 1

- (a) Which bee is the biggest in a colony, according to paragraph 1?

.....
 [1]

- (b) Using your own words, explain what the text means by:

- (i) 'special diet' (line 3)

.....
 [2]

- (ii) 'sole purpose' (line 5).

.....
 [2]

- (c) Re-read paragraph 3 ('Bees have different ... deep inside them.').

Give **two** characteristics that make the early bumblebee and the garden bumblebee different.

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[2]





(d) Re-read paragraphs 4 and 5 ('Plants can ... subject to study.').

(i) Identify **two** ways in which bee pollination is needed for plants.

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[2]

(ii) Explain how humans have benefited from the existence of bees.

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[3]

(e) Re-read paragraph 6 ('But bees ... costing us all.').

Why might some humans disregard the threats to bees?

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[3]



Read **Text B, *Beekeeping***, in the insert and then answer **Question 1(f)** on this question paper.

- (f) According to Text B, what should people consider and do before taking up beekeeping?

You must **use continuous writing** (not note form) and **use your own words** as far as possible.

Your summary should not be more than 120 words.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 5 marks for the quality of your writing.

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[15]

[Total: 30]



Read **Text C, *The business venture***, in the insert and then answer **Questions 2(a)–(d)** on this question paper.

Question 2

(a) Identify a word or phrase from the text which suggests the same idea as the words underlined:

(i) Abdul does not feel the same confidence about the future as Damian.

..... [1]

(ii) Abdul shared his very thorough research with Damian.

..... [1]

(iii) Damian wished to make his range of smoothies more varied.

..... [1]

(iv) Damian and Abdul look very thoughtfully at all the bees in the acacia tree.

..... [1]

(b) Using your own words, explain what the writer means by each of the words underlined:

A few months earlier, Damian and Abdul had been relaxing in Damian's field, near his beehives. It had been the first mild morning for many months and the two men were sipping Damian's home-made acacia honey and berry smoothies.

(i) relaxing [1]

(ii) mild [1]

(iii) sipping [1]





- (c) Use **one** example from the text below to explain how the writer suggests the thoughts and feelings of Damian about running his own business.

Use your own words in your explanation.

'I agree with that little bee,' announced Damian, smacking his lips in pleasure at the taste of honey and berries. 'We should venture out of our own hives and taste the sweet nectar of life. Get ahead of the crowd. Nice big shop in the middle of town.'

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[3]





(d) Re-read paragraphs 5 and 11.

- Paragraph 5 begins 'The delicate tracery ...' and is about Damian's view of the hive and acacia tree as a worker bee comes out to look for nectar.
- Paragraph 11 begins 'A worker bee ...' and is about a bee arriving in the kitchen as Damian thinks about his range of smoothies.

Explain how the writer uses language to convey meaning and to create effect in these paragraphs. Choose **three** examples of words or phrases from **each** paragraph to support your answer. Your choices should include the use of imagery.

Write about 200 to 300 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer.

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[Total: 25]



Re-read **Text C**, *The business venture*, in the insert and then answer **Question 3** on this question paper.

Question 3

You are Abdul. At the end of your first day selling smoothies at the market, you write a journal entry in which you reflect on your experiences.

In your journal entry you should:

- explain the most important considerations you had when wanting to set up the business
- explain your thoughts and feelings about your business partner, Damian, **and** the advantages and drawbacks of being in business together
- describe how you see your business developing in the future **and** any concerns you may have.

Write the words of the journal entry.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 10 marks for the quality of your writing.

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